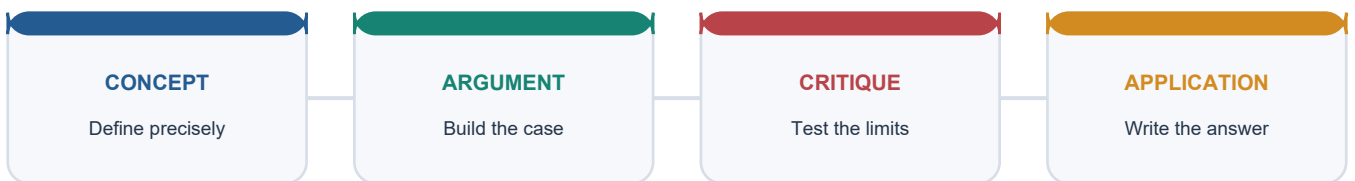


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Historical Background - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook | Original drills, verified PYQs and examiner-ready Mains models

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Historical Background - Solved Practice Workbook

This workbook contains exactly **32 original MCQs/drills** before the reproduced PYQ block. Correct answers rotate **ABCD** eight times. Reproduced PYQs are counted separately.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Rotation and method

- Original objective count: **32**.
- Correct-option sequence: ABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCD.
- Formats cover chronology, statements, comparison, institutional matching, operation and inference.

Q1. Which development best explains why Parliament began regulating Company government?

A. The 1765 Diwani gave the Company durable revenue and civil authority B. The 1600 charter immediately created Crown rule C. Plassey alone created a constitutional legislature D. The 1858 Act preceded Company territorial expansion

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** The Diwani granted revenue collection and civil-justice authority in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa. That fiscal base turned Company influence into durable territorial administration and created the accountability problem Parliament addressed.
- **B - Incorrect.** The 1600 charter authorised a trading corporation and monopoly privileges; it neither transferred Indian territory to the Crown nor established direct Crown government.
- **C - Incorrect.** Plassey increased Company influence in Bengal, but it did not create a legislature or by itself supply the durable revenue authority that followed the Diwani.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Crown transfer occurred in 1858, eighty-five years after the Regulating Act; it was the end of Company government, not the cause of Parliament's first regulatory intervention.

Examiner trap: Do not select the earliest British date; identify the event that converted influence into a revenue-backed territorial state.

Q2. The Regulating Act 1773 created the office of:

A. Governor-General of India B. Governor-General of Bengal C. Viceroy of India D. Secretary of State for India

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** The all-India title was created by the Charter Act 1833, when the Governor-General of Bengal became the Governor-General of India.
- **B - Correct.** The 1773 Act designated the Governor of Bengal as Governor-General of Bengal; Warren Hastings was the first holder of that office.
- **C - Incorrect.** The Governor-General also acquired the Crown-representative title of Viceroy only after the Government of India Act 1858.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Secretary of State for India was a British Cabinet office created in 1858, not an Indian executive office created in 1773.

Examiner trap: Keep the office-title sequence fixed: Governor-General of Bengal (1773), Governor-General of India (1833), Viceroy (1858).

Q3. The principal function of the Settlement Act 1781 was to:

A. introduce open civil-service competition B. create separate electorates C. clarify Supreme Court jurisdiction, exclude revenue matters and protect official acts D. abolish the Court of Directors

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** Open competitive civil-service recruitment belongs to the Charter Act 1853 and the Macaulay Committee of 1854, not the jurisdictional settlement of 1781.
- **B - Incorrect.** Separate Muslim electorates were introduced by the Indian Councils Act 1909, more than a century after the Settlement Act.
- **C - Correct.** The 1781 measure protected official acts, excluded revenue matters from the Supreme Court's reach and clarified the use of personal law and appellate routes.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Court of Directors survived until Crown rule began in 1858; the 1781 Act adjusted court-executive jurisdiction rather than abolishing Company institutions.

Examiner trap: The Settlement Act is a jurisdiction question, not a representation, recruitment or institutional-abolition question.

Q4. Under Pitt's India Act 1784, political supervision was assigned primarily to the:

A. Court of Directors B. Council of India C. Federal Court D. Board of Control

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Court of Directors retained Company commerce, administration and patronage; it was not the British governmental organ for political supervision.
- **B - Incorrect.** The Council of India advised the Secretary of State after 1858 and did not exist under Pitt's 1784 arrangement.
- **C - Incorrect.** The Federal Court was provided by the Government of India Act 1935 and opened in 1937; it had no role in eighteenth-century imperial supervision.
- **D - Correct.** Pitt's India Act created the Board of Control to supervise civil, military and revenue government while the Court of Directors continued Company management.

Examiner trap: Separate Company management from British political supervision: Court of Directors versus Board of Control.

Q5. Which pair is correctly distinguished?

A. Bengal Dual Government: 1765-72; metropolitan double government: Board of Control plus Court of Directors B. Both terms describe provincial dyarchy under 1919 C. Both began with the Charter Act 1833 D. Double government means Governor plus elected ministers under 1935

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** Bengal's Dual Government separated effective Company revenue power from the Nawab's nominal responsibility in 1765-72; Pitt's system divided metropolitan supervision between the Board of Control and Court of Directors.
- **B - Incorrect.** Provincial dyarchy was a 1919 division between reserved and transferred subjects; it was unrelated to either eighteenth-century arrangement.
- **C - Incorrect.** Bengal's Dual Government began after the 1765 Diwani and ended in 1772, while metropolitan double government began under Pitt's India Act 1784-not in 1833.
- **D - Incorrect.** The 1935 Act abolished provincial dyarchy and introduced provincial autonomy; "double government" is not a label for a Governor and elected ministers under that Act.

Examiner trap: Distinguish Bengal's 1765-72 Dual Government from Pitt's metropolitan double government after 1784.

Q6. A feature specifically associated with the Charter Act 1793 was:

A. complete abolition of the China trade monopoly B. renewal of Company monopoly for twenty years and extension of council-override power C. creation of the Governor-General of India D. introduction of provincial autonomy

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** The 1793 Act renewed rather than abolished monopoly. Indian trade was opened in 1813, and tea and China trade remained Company exceptions even then.
- **B - Correct.** The Charter Act 1793 renewed the Company's monopoly for twenty years and generalised the strengthened executive-override arrangement.
- **C - Incorrect.** The Governor-General of India was created by the Charter Act 1833; the 1793 settlement retained the existing Governor-General of Bengal framework.
- **D - Incorrect.** Provincial autonomy was introduced under the Government of India Act 1935, not an eighteenth-century Charter Act.

Examiner trap: Abolition, renewal and partial opening of monopoly occurred in different Charter Acts-1793, 1813 and 1833.

Q7. Consider the Charter Act 1813: 1. Tea and China monopoly remained. 2. An annual education sum was sanctioned. 3. Company government ended. Which are correct?

A. 1 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 2 only D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** Statement 1 is true, but statement 2 is also true because the Act sanctioned an annual sum for literature, learned Indians and scientific knowledge.
- **B - Incorrect.** Statement 2 is true, but statement 3 is false: Company government continued until the Crown transfer of 1858.
- **C - Correct.** The tea-and-China exceptions remained and the annual education grant was authorised; the Act did not terminate Company administration.
- **D - Incorrect.** Including statement 3 makes this combination wrong because the East India Company continued to govern after 1813.

Examiner trap: In statement combinations, remember that 1813 changed trade and education but did not end Company government.

Q8. Which statement about the 1813 education provision is most accurate?

A. It mandated English as the sole medium B. It created universal primary schooling C. It transferred education to elected provincial ministers D. It funded learning but did not itself settle the English-versus-Oriental controversy

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** The 1813 statute did not prescribe English as the sole medium; the Anglicist-Orientalist settlement belongs to later policy developments.
- **B - Incorrect.** An annual grant for learning was not a system of universal primary education and did not create mass schooling.
- **C - Incorrect.** Elected provincial ministers did not exist in 1813; education became a transferred provincial subject only under the 1919 dyarchy scheme.
- **D - Correct.** The Act funded literature, learned Indians and scientific knowledge but left the medium and direction of education unresolved.

Examiner trap: Do not import the later Anglicist policy debate or twentieth-century provincial ministries into the 1813 grant.

Q9. The Charter Act 1833 is correctly linked with:

A. Governor-General of India and centralised all-India legislation B. first Viceroy and Secretary of State C. provincial dyarchy D. separate Muslim electorates

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** The Charter Act 1833 created the Governor-General of India, with William Bentinck first, and concentrated legislative authority at the all-India centre.
- **B - Incorrect.** The Viceroy and Secretary of State system belongs to the Crown transfer under the Government of India Act 1858.
- **C - Incorrect.** Provincial dyarchy was introduced under the Government of India Act 1919.
- **D - Incorrect.** Separate Muslim electorates were introduced under the Indian Councils Act 1909.

Examiner trap: Attach each reform device to its own year: all-India centralisation 1833, Crown transfer 1858, electorates 1909, dyarchy 1919.

Q10. Which proposition best describes the Company after the Charter Act 1833?

A. It was abolished immediately B. Its commercial functions ended, but its administrative rule continued C. It retained tea trade monopoly until 1858 D. It became responsible to an elected Indian legislature

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Company was not abolished until 1858; the 1833 Act ended its commercial functions while retaining it as the governing agency.
- **B - Correct.** After 1833 the Company ceased trading and held territories as an administrative body, so commercial termination preceded sovereign transfer.
- **C - Incorrect.** The 1833 Act ended all Company commercial activity; the tea-and-China exception had survived only under the earlier 1813 arrangement.
- **D - Incorrect.** The central legislature remained colonial and the executive was not responsible to an elected Indian legislature.

Examiner trap: Commercial extinction in 1833 and political extinction in 1858 are separate milestones.

Q11. Which change belongs to 1853 rather than 1833?

A. creation of Governor-General of India B. end of Company trade C. Separation of legislative and executive work in the Governor-General's council D. withdrawal of Presidency legislative powers

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Governor-General of India and William Bentinck's new title belong to the Charter Act 1833.
- **B - Incorrect.** The Company's commercial functions ended under the Charter Act 1833, not 1853.
- **C - Correct.** The 1853 Act added a distinct legislative wing to the Governor-General's council and thereby differentiated legislative from executive work.
- **D - Incorrect.** Bombay and Madras lost legislative authority under the centralising Charter Act 1833.

Examiner trap: Use 1833 for centralisation and de-commercialisation; use 1853 for legislative specialisation and competition.

Q12. The four local members added under the Charter Act 1853 represented:

A. four directly elected mass constituencies B. four princely-state chambers C. four communal electorates D. Madras, Bombay, Bengal and Agra through provincial-government channels

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** The four members were not returned by mass constituencies; direct elections at the central level came much later under the 1919 settlement.
- **B - Incorrect.** They represented provincial governments, not chambers of princely states; the Chamber of Princes was inaugurated in 1921.

- **C - Incorrect.** Communal electorates were introduced in 1909 and were not the basis of the 1853 local members.
- **D - Correct.** Four of the six additional legislative councillors came through Madras, Bombay, Bengal and Agra, giving local-government representation without popular election.

Examiner trap: "Local representation" in 1853 meant provincial-government channels, not popular, princely or communal constituencies.

Q13. The Government of India Act 1858:

A. abolished Company government and transferred power to the Crown B. introduced central dyarchy C. created the Federal Court D. introduced separate electorates

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** The 1858 Act abolished the East India Company and transferred government to the Crown after the Revolt of 1857.
- **B - Incorrect.** Central dyarchy was proposed by the Government of India Act 1935 and never commenced.
- **C - Incorrect.** The Government of India Act 1935 provided the Federal Court, which opened in 1937.
- **D - Incorrect.** Separate Muslim electorates were introduced by the Indian Councils Act 1909.

Examiner trap: The 1858 Act is about transfer of sovereignty and metropolitan control, not later electoral or judicial institutions.

Q14. Which institutional pair was abolished in 1858?

A. Governor-General and provincial governors B. Court of Directors and Board of Control C. Supreme Court and High Courts D. Legislative Assembly and Council of State

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Governor-General and provincial governors continued; the Governor-General additionally acted as Viceroy after the Crown transfer.
- **B - Correct.** The Court of Directors and Board of Control-the two arms of metropolitan double government-were abolished when Company rule ended.
- **C - Incorrect.** The Calcutta Supreme Court was not abolished by the 1858 transfer, and the statutory High Courts were established later under the 1861 legislation.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Legislative Assembly and Council of State were created under the 1919 bicameral settlement and did not exist in 1858.

Examiner trap: Identify what metropolitan double government contained before deciding which institutions the Crown transfer abolished.

Q15. The 1861 Act associated Indians with legislation mainly through:

A. universal adult election B. a separate Muslim electorate C. nomination as non-official members D. responsible provincial cabinets

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** Universal adult election was not introduced under colonial rule; the 1861 members were nominated.
- **B - Incorrect.** Separate Muslim electorates first appeared under the 1909 reforms, not in 1861.
- **C - Correct.** The 1861 Act enabled the Viceroy to nominate Indian non-official members for legislative work, creating association without electoral responsibility.
- **D - Incorrect.** Responsible provincial ministries emerged only in limited form under 1919 dyarchy and more fully under 1935 provincial autonomy.

Examiner trap: The textbook phrase "representative institutions" in 1861 must not be converted into elected or responsible government.

Q16. Which combination belongs to the Indian Councils Act 1892?

A. provincial autonomy and universal franchise B. central dyarchy and three lists C. Federal Court and Joint PSCs D. budget discussion, questions and recommendation-based selection with official majority retained

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** Provincial autonomy belongs to 1935, while universal adult franchise came only with the Constitution.
- **B - Incorrect.** Central dyarchy and the three-list federal scheme were provisions of the Government of India Act 1935.
- **C - Incorrect.** The Federal Court and federal/provincial/joint PSC scheme belong to the 1935 Act, with the Court opening in 1937.
- **D - Correct.** The 1892 Act enlarged councils, permitted budget discussion and questions, and used nomination on recommendation while preserving official majorities.

Examiner trap: Budget discussion and questions indicate scrutiny; they do not amount to provincial autonomy or cabinet responsibility.

Q17. A separate electorate differs from reservation in a joint electorate because it:

A. uses a community-specific electorate to choose the community's representative B. guarantees a seat while all voters share one electoral roll C. abolishes community-based representation D. makes the executive legislature-responsible

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** A separate electorate uses a distinct community electoral roll so that the community's voters choose its designated representative.
- **B - Incorrect.** This describes reservation within a joint electorate-the mechanism adopted for depressed classes after the Poona Pact-not a separate electorate.
- **C - Incorrect.** Separate electorates institutionalise rather than abolish community-based representation.
- **D - Incorrect.** Electoral design does not by itself make the executive responsible to the legislature; responsibility concerns the executive's political tenure.

Examiner trap: Ask who votes, not merely who receives a seat: the electoral roll separates a separate electorate from joint-electorate reservation.

Q18. Under the 1909 reforms:

A. the Centre became responsible to an elected lower house B. the Centre retained an official majority while provinces had non-official majorities of mixed composition C. provincial dyarchy began D. separate electorates were abolished

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** The 1909 reforms enlarged councils but did not make the central executive dependent on the confidence of an elected lower house.
- **B - Correct.** An official majority remained at the Centre; provincial non-official majorities combined elected and nominated elements and did not end executive control.
- **C - Incorrect.** Provincial dyarchy was introduced by the Government of India Act 1919.
- **D - Incorrect.** The 1909 Act introduced, rather than abolished, separate Muslim electorates.

Examiner trap: A non-official majority can include nominated interests and does not automatically make the executive legislature-responsible.

Q19. Under provincial dyarchy in 1919, which was generally a transferred subject?

A. police B. finance C. education D. land revenue

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** Police was a reserved subject administered by the Governor and Executive Council, not a transferred field handled by responsible ministers.
- **B - Incorrect.** Finance remained reserved, which was a central reason transferred ministers lacked the resources needed to implement policy.
- **C - Correct.** Education was transferred to ministers responsible to the provincial legislative council under the 1919 dyarchy arrangement.
- **D - Incorrect.** Land revenue was reserved because the colonial executive retained control over core fiscal administration.

Examiner trap: Under 1919 dyarchy, social-development departments were generally transferred; finance and coercive departments remained reserved.

Q20. Why was provincial dyarchy structurally weak?

A. All subjects were transferred to elected ministers B. Governors lost override powers C. The franchise was universal D. Ministers bore responsibility without controlling key finance and coercive departments

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** Only selected social and developmental departments were transferred; finance, police, justice and land revenue remained reserved.
- **B - Incorrect.** Governors retained overriding authority and administered reserved subjects with their executive councils.
- **C - Incorrect.** The franchise remained limited by property, tax, education and related qualifications; it was not universal.
- **D - Correct.** Ministers answered publicly for transferred departments but lacked control over key fiscal and coercive instruments, producing responsibility without effective authority.

Examiner trap: Test dyarchy through functions, finances and final authority; formal ministerial office alone did not create responsibility.

Q21. Which combination was introduced at the Centre by the 1919 Act?

A. bicameralism and direct elections under a limited franchise B. provincial autonomy and a functioning federation C. universal adult franchise and joint electorates only D. a Supreme Court and CAG

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** The 1919 Act replaced the single central legislature with the Council of State and Legislative Assembly and introduced direct elections under a restricted franchise.
- **B - Incorrect.** Provincial autonomy and the proposed All-India Federation belong to the 1935 Act; the federation never commenced.
- **C - Incorrect.** Universal adult franchise was a constitutional departure after independence, while separate electorates were actually extended in 1919.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Supreme Court belongs to the Constitution and the CAG to the post-1950 constitutional structure; neither was created by the 1919 Act.

Examiner trap: Central bicameralism and direct election arrived in 1919, but universal franchise and a responsible central cabinet did not.

Q22. Which statement about the Simon Commission is correct?

A. It was constituted by the Constituent Assembly B. All seven members were British and its review fed a longer process leading to 1935 C. It directly enacted the Poona Pact D. It brought the 1935 federation into operation

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Simon Commission was appointed by the British Government under the 1919 statutory-review provision, not by the Constituent Assembly.
- **B - Correct.** All seven commissioners were British; its report fed into the Round Tables, White Paper and Joint Select Committee process preceding 1935.
- **C - Incorrect.** The Poona Pact resulted from the 1932 Communal Award controversy and negotiations involving Gandhi and Ambedkar, not from the Commission.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Commission recommended federation, but it neither enacted the 1935 Act nor brought the uncommenced federal scheme into operation.

Examiner trap: The Simon Commission was one stage in a longer 1927-35 chain; do not credit it with the Poona Pact or commencement of federation.

Q23. The Poona Pact is best described as:

A. separate electorates for depressed classes retained unchanged B. universal adult suffrage C. reserved seats for depressed classes within joint electorates D. abolition of all communal representation in 1932

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Communal Award proposed separate electorates for depressed classes, but the Poona Pact replaced that element.
- **B - Incorrect.** The Pact operated within a restricted colonial franchise and did not introduce universal adult suffrage.
- **C - Correct.** The Pact provided reserved seats for depressed classes while retaining a joint Hindu electorate.
- **D - Incorrect.** It modified only the depressed-classes component of the Communal Award; other communal representation did not disappear in 1932.

Examiner trap: The Poona Pact changed the electorate mechanism for depressed classes, not the entire communal-representation system.

Q24. Which 1935 feature did not commence?

A. provincial autonomy B. Federal Court C. provincial elections D. All-India Federation and central dyarchy

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** Provincial autonomy was implemented after the 1937 elections, although governors retained safeguards.
- **B - Incorrect.** The Federal Court was established in 1937 under the Act's institutional provisions.
- **C - Incorrect.** Provincial elections occurred in 1937 and produced ministries; they were not an uncommenced feature.
- **D - Correct.** The princely-state accession condition failed, so the All-India Federation and its associated central dyarchy never commenced.

Examiner trap: For every 1935 option, ask separately whether the Act provided it and whether it actually commenced.

Q25. Under the Government of India Act 1935, residuary authority was vested in the:

A. Governor-General B. Federal Legislature C. Provincial Legislatures D. Federal Court

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** The 1935 Act left residuary allocation with the Governor-General rather than assigning unenumerated subjects automatically to a legislature.
- **B - Incorrect.** The Federal Legislature received enumerated Federal and Concurrent powers but not a general residuary competence.
- **C - Incorrect.** Provincial legislatures were limited to the Provincial and shared Concurrent fields, subject to the Act's safeguards.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Federal Court adjudicated legal disputes; it did not allocate residuary legislative subjects.

Examiner trap: Residuary allocation is a legislative-power question; do not confuse the Governor-General's role with the Federal Court's adjudicatory role.

Q26. Which comparison is correct?

A. 1909 introduced provincial dyarchy; 1919 abolished it B. 1919 introduced provincial dyarchy; 1935 abolished it and introduced provincial autonomy C. 1935 introduced provincial dyarchy and 1947 abolished it D. 1919 introduced central dyarchy and 1935 provincial dyarchy

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** The 1909 Act introduced separate electorates; it neither created nor abolished provincial dyarchy.
- **B - Correct.** The 1919 Act divided provincial subjects into reserved and transferred categories; the 1935 Act ended that provincial dyarchy and substituted autonomy.
- **C - Incorrect.** The 1935 Act-not the Independence Act-abolished provincial dyarchy; 1947 changed sovereignty and dominion status.
- **D - Incorrect.** The sequence is reversed: 1919 placed dyarchy in provinces, while 1935 proposed it at the Centre and did not commence that federal part.

Examiner trap: Dyarchy changes location across the Acts: provinces in 1919; proposed Centre in 1935, where it never operated.

Q27. Which institution began functioning in 1937 under the 1935 settlement?

A. Supreme Court at Calcutta B. Central Public Service Commission C. Federal Court D. Board of Control

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Calcutta Supreme Court began in 1774 and was not an institution first functioning under the 1935 settlement.
- **B - Incorrect.** The Central Public Service Commission was established in 1926 under the path opened by the 1919 Act.
- **C - Correct.** The Government of India Act 1935 provided the Federal Court, and it opened in 1937.
- **D - Incorrect.** The Board of Control was created in 1784 and abolished in 1858.

Examiner trap: Institutional dates are staggered: Calcutta Court 1774, Central PSC 1926, Federal Court 1937.

Q28. Which formulation is safest?

A. The Government of India Act 1935 alone created the RBI statute B. The RBI was created by the 1919 Act C. The RBI began only after the Constitution D. The RBI was created by the RBI Act 1934 and began in 1935; the constitutional settlement belongs to the same institutional era

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Reserve Bank's constituting statute was the Reserve Bank of India Act 1934; attributing its legal creation solely to the 1935 constitutional Act is imprecise.

- **B - Incorrect.** The 1919 Act concerned dyarchy, bicameralism, elections and a public-service commission path, not the creation of the RBI.
- **C - Incorrect.** The RBI began operations in 1935, fifteen years before the Constitution commenced.
- **D - Correct.** This formulation preserves both statutes and chronology: the RBI Act 1934 created the institution, which began operating during the 1935 constitutional period.

Examiner trap: Differentiate the RBI's constituting statute from the wider constitutional settlement in which it began operating.

Q29. The lapse of British paramountcy in 1947 meant that princely states:

- A. required accession and integration through subsequent legal-political action
 B. automatically became Indian states
 C. automatically became Pakistani provinces
 D. remained permanently under the British Crown

Answer: A.

- **A - Correct.** The end of Crown paramountcy removed the imperial relationship; accession and integration then required instruments, negotiation and Indian state action.
- **B - Incorrect.** No clause automatically absorbed every princely state into India when paramountcy lapsed.
- **C - Incorrect.** States did not automatically become Pakistani provinces either; accession choices and geography had to be addressed politically and legally.
- **D - Incorrect.** British paramountcy ended on the appointed day, so the princely states did not remain permanently under Crown authority.

Examiner trap: Lapse of paramountcy removed British suzerainty; it did not itself choose or complete accession.

Q30. What changed most decisively for the Constituent Assembly after the Independence Act?

- A. It was first created in August 1947
 B. It became a sovereign constitution-making and legislative body free to repeal British statutes
 C. It lost legislative power
 D. It became subordinate to the British Parliament

Answer: B.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Constituent Assembly first met in December 1946 under the Cabinet Mission framework; the Independence Act did not create it.
- **B - Correct.** After the 1947 Act the Assembly could legislate for the Dominion, frame its Constitution and repeal British statutes without imperial permission.
- **C - Incorrect.** The Assembly gained, rather than lost, legislative authority by also serving as the Dominion legislature.
- **D - Incorrect.** British parliamentary supremacy ended for the Dominion; the Assembly was no longer subordinate to Westminster in constitution-making.

Examiner trap: Separate the Assembly's formation in 1946 from its sovereign legal status after 15 August 1947.

Q31. Which colonial feature was rejected rather than retained in 1950?

- A. three-list distribution
 B. public service commissions
 C. separate communal electorates
 D. the office of Governor

Answer: C.

- **A - Incorrect.** The three-list method was retained and redesigned in the Seventh Schedule rather than rejected.
- **B - Incorrect.** Public service commissions were retained and constitutionalised through Articles 315-323.
- **C - Correct.** The Constitution rejected separate communal electorates and adopted common electoral citizenship, with specified reservations operating within joint electorates.
- **D - Incorrect.** The office of Governor was retained but transformed by constitutional limits and responsible government.

Examiner trap: Classify colonial devices as retained, transformed or rejected; the three lists, PSCs and Governor were not discarded like separate electorates.

Q32. Choose the correct chronological-institutional sequence:

A. GG India 1773 -> Viceroy 1833 -> dyarchy 1909 -> autonomy 1919 B. Viceroy 1773 -> GG India 1858 -> autonomy 1909 -> dyarchy 1935 C. GG Bengal 1784 -> Secretary of State 1813 -> Viceroy 1853 -> federation operating 1935 D. GG Bengal 1773 -> GG India 1833 -> Viceroy 1858 -> provincial dyarchy 1919 -> provincial autonomy 1935

Answer: D.

- **A - Incorrect.** The Regulating Act created the Governor-General of Bengal, not India; dyarchy belongs to 1919 and provincial autonomy to 1935.
- **B - Incorrect.** The Viceroy title did not exist in 1773, and the sequence incorrectly assigns autonomy to 1909 and dyarchy to 1935 provinces.
- **C - Incorrect.** The Board of Control dates to 1784, the Secretary of State to 1858 and the 1935 federation never operated.
- **D - Correct.** This sequence correctly distinguishes the 1773 Bengal title, 1833 all-India title, 1858 Viceroy, 1919 provincial dyarchy and 1935 provincial autonomy.

Examiner trap: Chronology questions often mix a correct institution with the wrong year; verify every link in the sequence, not only its endpoints.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Objective PYQ provenance and key discipline

- Objective PYQs reproduced: **4**.
- Direct owner: **2024 Prelims GS-I Q62**.
- Cross-owned but indispensable here: **2018 Q38, 2019 Q4, 2023 Q50**.
- Direct owned Mains PYQs in the audited 2018-2025 GS-I/GS-II ledgers: **0**.
- An answer letter appears only where a final official/local-official key is available.

PYQ 1 - 2018 Prelims GS-I Q38 (cross-owned; relevant)

Question: In the federation established by the Government of India Act of 1935, residuary powers were given to the:

A. Federal Legislature B. Governor-General C. Provincial Legislature D. Provincial Governors

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Concept analysis: The enacted scheme vested residuary allocation in the Governor-General. The stem's word "established" must be read with caution because the Act provided the federation but the federal part never commenced.

PYQ 2 - 2019 Prelims GS-I Q4 (cross-owned; relevant)

Question: Consider the following statements about the Charter Act of 1813:

1. It ended the trade monopoly of the East India Company in India except for trade in tea and trade with China.
2. It asserted the sovereignty of the British Crown over the Indian territories held by the Company.
3. The revenues of India were now controlled by the British Parliament.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Concept analysis: Statements 1 and 2 match the statutory account; statement 3 overstates the change. Company administration and fiscal machinery continued.

PYQ 3 - 2023 Prelims GS-I Q50 (cross-owned; relevant)

Question: By which one of the following Acts was the Governor-General of Bengal designated as the Governor-General of India?

A. The Regulating Act B. The Pitt's India Act C. The Charter Act of 1793 D. The Charter Act of 1833

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Concept analysis: The Regulating Act created the Governor-General of Bengal; the all-India title belongs to the Charter Act 1833. The letter is withheld because no final official key is held locally.

PYQ 4 - 2024 Prelims GS-I Q62 (direct owner)

Question: With reference to the Government of India Act, 1935, consider the following statements:

1. It provided for the establishment of an All India Federation based on the union of the British Indian Provinces and Princely States.
2. Defence and Foreign Affairs were kept under the control of the federal legislature.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 1 only B. 2 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A.

Official-key status: The locally held final official UPSC Set-A key records A. Statement 1 is correct as a provision even though the federation never commenced. Statement 2 is false because defence and external affairs were reserved under the Governor-General.

Direct Mains PYQ audit

No direct owned Mains PYQ was found in the audited local GS-I/GS-II routing ledgers for 2018-2025. None is invented or imported merely because it mentions colonial rule.

Original Q1 - 10 marks / 150 words

Question: Examine how parliamentary regulation transformed the East India Company from 1773 to 1858.

Demand and answer plan

Build a five-stage causal sequence: 1773 parliamentary regulation, 1784 dual control, 1833 de-commercialisation and centralisation, 1853 legislative/service specialisation, and 1858 Crown transfer. Distinguish tighter British supervision from Indian democratic accountability.

Model answer

The East India Company's transformation was a staged construction of public control over a corporation that had acquired territorial power. The Regulating Act 1773 created the Governor-General of Bengal, subordinated the other Presidencies in key matters and established the Calcutta Supreme Court. Pitt's India Act 1784 then separated Company commerce from political supervision through the Court of Directors and Board of Control. The Charter Acts narrowed monopoly, with 1833 ending Company trade and creating the Governor-General of India, while 1853 differentiated legislative work and competitive recruitment.

These reforms made Company administration increasingly state-like, centralised and answerable to British authorities. Yet the arrangement remained indirect and divided. The Revolt of 1857 exposed its political limits, leading the 1858 Act to abolish the Company and transfer government to the Crown through the Secretary of State and Viceroy.

Thus regulation first converted the Company from trader-ruler into an administrative agency; Crown transfer completed, rather than began, that transformation.

Why this answer is examiner-ready

The answer uses chronology to demonstrate institutional transformation rather than reciting Acts, and its final distinction-commercial change before sovereign transfer-directly resolves the question.

Original Q2 - 10 marks / 150 words

Question: Trace the evolution from association to responsible government between 1861 and 1935.

Demand and answer plan

Organise the answer as a representation ladder: 1861 nomination, 1892 scrutiny, 1909 segmented election, 1919 divided ministerial responsibility and 1935 guarded provincial autonomy. End by explaining why association and election were still short of full responsibility.

Model answer

The movement from association to responsibility was gradual and tightly controlled. The 1861 Act admitted nominated Indian non-officials and restored provincial legislative powers, but gave them no control over the executive. The 1892 Act added budget discussion, questions and recommendation-based selection, creating scrutiny without confidence responsibility. The 1909 reforms enlarged councils and introduced separate Muslim electorates, widening representation while segmenting the electorate.

The 1919 Act made the first limited executive experiment through provincial dyarchy: ministers were responsible for transferred subjects, while finance, police and other reserved fields remained with the Governor and Executive Council. This mismatch weakened responsibility. The 1935 Act abolished provincial dyarchy and introduced provincial autonomy with ministries responsible to elected legislatures, although governors retained safeguards.

The trajectory was nomination, scrutiny, segmented election, divided responsibility and guarded autonomy. Full responsible government based on universal adult suffrage arrived only under the Constitution.

Why this answer is examiner-ready

The answer earns value by naming the precise constitutional gain and surviving control at every stage, then comparing the colonial ladder with universal-franchise responsible government after 1950.

Original Q3 - 15 marks / 250 words

Question: Analyse why dyarchy under the Government of India Act 1919 failed to create responsible provincial government.

Demand and answer plan

Answer the causal word "why" through functions, finances and final authority. Name transferred and reserved subjects, show their interdependence, add Governor override and restricted franchise, then acknowledge the limited administrative experience dyarchy created.

Model answer

Dyarchy divided provincial subjects but separated political responsibility from effective authority. Transferred subjects such as education, public health, agriculture and local government were administered by Indian ministers answerable to provincial legislatures. Reserved subjects such as finance, police, justice, prisons and land revenue remained with the Governor and Executive Council, which was not legislature-responsible.

This created three defects. Ministers could formulate social policy but lacked finance and coercive administration. Functionally connected departments were split, obstructing coherent policy. The Governor also retained overriding authority, while restricted franchise and communal electorates weakened legitimacy.

Dyarchy was not institutionally empty: it gave Indian leaders administrative experience and enlarged debate. Yet those gains exposed its central contradiction - public accountability without unified power. The Simon Commission recommended ending provincial dyarchy, and the 1935 Act replaced it with provincial autonomy, though safeguards survived.

Therefore, dyarchy failed not because Indians were incapable of administration, but because the design withheld the finances, functionaries and final authority required for responsible government.

Why this answer is examiner-ready

The response links the subject split to concrete governance failure, includes a fair counterpoint and explains why 1935 replaced provincial dyarchy rather than merely declaring it unsuccessful.

Original Q4 - 15 marks / 250 words

Question: Critically examine the statement that the Government of India Act 1935 established a federation in India.

Demand and answer plan

Treat "established" critically by separating legal design from operational commencement. Cover units, lists, residuary power and central dyarchy; then contrast the uncommenced federation with operating provincial autonomy and the Federal Court before evaluating safeguards and legacy.

Model answer

The 1935 Act designed an All-India Federation, but it did not establish an operating federation. Its proposed units were British Indian provinces and acceding princely states. It distributed subjects through Federal, Provincial and Concurrent Lists and vested residuary allocation in the Governor-General. It also proposed central dyarchy, with defence and external affairs reserved.

Entry of princely states depended on accession conditions that were never fulfilled. Consequently, the federal part and central dyarchy did not commence. What operated was the provincial part: dyarchy was abolished, elections were held in 1937 and responsible ministries functioned under safeguards. The Federal Court also opened in 1937.

Even the proposed federation was not democratically balanced. The Governor-General retained discretion and special responsibilities; representation was unequal and franchise restricted. These safeguards reveal a federation designed to preserve imperial command.

The Act nevertheless mattered greatly. Its lists, Governors, service commissions, Federal Court and administrative detail influenced the Constitution. The precise verdict is therefore: a federal blueprint and operating provincial autonomy, but no functioning All-India Federation.

Why this answer is examiner-ready

The answer does not accept the premise uncritically: it gives a precise provided-versus-operated verdict and still explains why the unrealised design influenced the Constitution.

Original Q5 - 20 marks / 250 words

Question: The Constitution is both a culmination of colonial constitutional development and a repudiation of colonial rule. Discuss.

Demand and answer plan

Use two balanced halves: institutional continuity and democratic rupture. In the continuity half, trace central authority, legislatures, services, federal lists and courts; in the rupture half, contrast imperial sovereignty, restricted franchise and communal electorates with rights, adult suffrage and responsible government.

Model answer

The Constitution did not begin on a blank institutional page, but neither did it merely continue colonial government. British statutes created a centralised executive, legislatures, courts, professional services and a federal-administrative vocabulary. The Constitution inherited this machinery while changing its sovereign source, democratic purpose and legal limits.

The continuity is substantial. The Acts of 1773 and 1833 built central authority. The 1853 Act differentiated legislative work and competitive recruitment. The Councils Acts introduced portfolio allocation, representation, budget discussion and questions. The 1919 Act separated subjects, created central bicameralism and provided a public-service commission. Above all, the 1935 Act supplied the three-list scheme, Governors, provincial autonomy, Federal Court, PSCs and administrative detail. The 1947 Act preserved this machinery temporarily while making the Constituent Assembly sovereign.

The rupture is equally decisive. Colonial institutions rested on imperial sovereignty, official majorities, restricted franchise, communal electorates, executive vetoes and safeguards. The Constitution replaced them with popular sovereignty, a republic, universal adult suffrage, joint electoral citizenship, Fundamental Rights, constitutional remedies, judicial review and a responsible parliamentary executive.

Thus 1950 was a culmination in institutional form and a repudiation in political legitimacy: inherited state capacity was constitutionalised and democratised.

Why this answer is examiner-ready

The model sustains the "both" in the directive, supports each side with named statutes and avoids the two weak absolutes that the Constitution was either a copy or wholly without institutional ancestry.

Original Q6 - 20 marks / 250 words

Question: Evaluate the colonial evolution of the judiciary, public services, financial control and audit, and its constitutional legacy.

Demand and answer plan

Use four institutional strands-judiciary, services, financial control and audit. For each, name the colonial milestones, identify the functional inheritance and state the post-1950 transformation in jurisdiction, equality, independence or accountability.

Model answer

The less-visible legacy of British rule lies in institutions that converted territorial power into a routinised state. Their post-independence value arose only after democratic transformation.

Judicially, the 1773 Act provided the Calcutta Supreme Court, whose conflict with the executive required the 1781 settlement. The Indian High Courts Act 1861 reorganised superior courts, while the 1935 Act provided the Federal Court, opened in 1937. This formed institutional ancestry for the Supreme Court, but colonial courts lacked the Constitution's rights jurisdiction and supremacy.

In public services, Company patronage gave way to an unrealised opening principle in 1833, open competition under 1853 and the Macaulay Committee. The 1919 Act provided a Public Service Commission, established in 1926, and 1935 provided federal, provincial and joint commissions. Articles 315-323 retained the commission model under equality and representative government.

Financial accountability widened through budget discussion in 1892 and separate provincial budgets in 1919. The RBI derived from the RBI Act 1934 and began in 1935; the 1935 constitutional settlement also provided an Auditor-General for federal and provincial accounts.

The legacy is institutional continuity without normative identity. Courts, services, finance and audit were retained because modern government required them; independence replaced imperial command with legislative accountability, constitutional review and public sovereignty.

Why this answer is examiner-ready

The answer keeps institutional ancestry distinct from constitutional identity, uses the RBI Act 1934 and Auditor-General qualification accurately, and reaches an evaluative rather than celebratory conclusion.